KEDMA'S EMERGENCY RESPONSE TO OPERATION ROARING LION: CORE ACTIVITIES AND UPDATES

As you know, over the past week Israel has entered another complex security chapter. Ongoing military operations involving Iran, alongside active fighting on the northern border with Hezbollah in Lebanon, have created a renewed atmosphere of uncertainty across the country.
UAV attacks have also reached communities in the Golan and the Arava, while security operations continue along the Gaza border. The result is a multi-front reality that places many communities across Israel under renewed pressure during an already fragile period.

For communities nationwide, this is a challenging and emotionally demanding period.
For those living along Israel's borders, particularly in the North -the impact is immediate, placing renewed pressure on communities that had only just begun to regain stability. After more than a year of evacuation, families who recently returned home now find themselves facing sirens and uncertainty once again, placing additional strain on communities, and heightening concerns about long-term demographic sustainability in the Galilee.

Below is a brief overview of what we've done so far, and how we continue to stand by our communities:

Since the beginning of the current escalation, Kedma has activated its community response framework across all districts, with particular focus on the North.

Rather than isolated projects, our response centers on sustaining daily life and reinforcing community resilience through:

Supporting the Northern communities

While Kedma is active across the South, East, and national hubs, the Northern District currently demands intensified attention.

As educational systems are currently suspended, and residents are operating in proximity to secure rooms and shelters.

Our student villages are, in many cases, serving as an operational backbone for local resilience, supporting children during morning hours, assisting elderly residents, and providing one-on-one mentoring where needed.

For communities still rebuilding after prolonged evacuation, many of which have not yet completed the physical restoration of homes and local infrastructure, this renewed instability brings both emotional and logistical strain. Kedma's consistent presence ensures that these communities are not navigating this period alone.

Support for Evacuated Families

The current security situation has once again created a reality in which families are being forced to leave their homes. As of now, 2,436 civilians have been evacuated; 1,927 are currently staying in hotels in Eilat, while others have relocated temporarily with relatives or host communities.

Kedma volunteers are in Eilat, providing ongoing recreational and educational activities for children and supporting families during this period of displacement. Our teams remain present at the hotels, helping create a sense of stability, routine, and community during an uncertain time.

Strengthening Informal Education Frameworks

With formal education systems currently closed, Kedma's teams are operating and reinforcing informal education programs for children and youth-providing safe spaces, structured activities, and emotional stability during this period.

This effort is especially critical in northern border communities such as Misgav Am, Manara, Metula, Kfar Yuval, Kfar Sold, Lehavot HaBashan, Mitzpeh Ramon, Kfar HaNassi, and Shtula, where our villages are actively supporting local education efforts.

Community Activation & Holiday Programming

Despite the security situation, maintaining communal spirit remains vital. Across multiple districts, Kedma's teams organized Purim activities, community gatherings, and children's events- reinforcing connection and continuity in places where routine has been repeatedly disrupted.

In the southern border communities, this included holiday parades, children's programming, and support for non-formal education frameworks in kibbutzim and regional councils.

In the Ramat Negev region, our volunteers operated childcare centers in protected shelters to support parents who are enlisted or essential workers. Beyond providing a safe space during alerts, these shelters have also become unexpected hubs of community life—places where families can gather, children can play, and neighbors can reconnect even under challenging circumstances.

Support for Soldiers, Reservists, and Essential Workers

From operating "warm corners" for soldiers, to hosting reserve units, to community-led laundry initiatives for reservists- Kedma communities are mobilizing in practical, hands-on ways to support those serving and protecting the country in close proximity to border communities.

Assistance to Vulnerable Populations & Local Agriculture

Our communities continue supporting elderly residents, individuals with special needs, and local farmers - ensuring that even amid escalation, essential social and economic lifelines remain intact.

Immediate Funding Priorities

Following a rapid needs assessment conducted across our active communities, Kedma has identified several urgent intervention areas that require immediate philanthropic support. These needs arise directly from field realities and are essential to sustaining community resilience during this period.

1. Resilience Care Packages

Strengthening morale is an inseparable part of strengthening national resilience.

The Goal: To assemble and distribute 1,500 resilience care packages for Kedma activists, children and youth in border communities, and soldiers stationed in our areas of operation.

These packages provide practical comfort items and symbolic encouragement during prolonged uncertainty - reinforcing solidarity, morale, and emotional strength.

2. Protected Transportation & Logistics Under Fire

Due to the security situation, public transportation has been suspended. To maintain our presence and ensure continuity of programming within our border communities, it is necessary to provide secure and reliable transportation solutions for our teams.

The Need includes:

- Protected transport for Kedma's volunteers to border communities
- Fuel coverage, trained drivers, and reinforced logistical support

Given elevated risk levels and limited availability, daily operational costs for protected vehicles are significantly higher than routine transportation.

3. Thermal Protection - Winter Gear for Border community Volunteers

Extended hours in open areas, guard posts, and night patrols during the winter place significant physical strain on volunteers and security teams in border communities.

The Need: High-quality thermal clothing sets (top and bottom) designed to retain body heat during prolonged outdoor activity.

Target population: 500 Kedma volunteers and young adults, as well as reservists and local rapid-response teams operating in our partner communities.

4. Emotional Resilience Support – On-Site Social Workers

The emotional pressure on field managers and community leaders is immense. To provide professional tools for coping and prevent burnout, Kedma is establishing an immediate emotional support framework.

The Need: licensed social workers (one per district)

Scope: 10 hours of availability per day, for one month (approximately 22 working days)

5.First Aid Kits for Shelters

To strengthen emergency preparedness, we aim to equip shelters in the communities we work with. We are seeking to purchase approximately 100 fully equipped first aid kits to ensure that each shelter has immediate access to essential medical supplies and basic emergency care equipment in case of emergencies.

KEDMA

Total Expenses

Areas of intervention	Description	Requested Budget (USD)
Resilience Care Packages	Distribution of 1,500 care and resilience packages for Kedma volunteers, youth in border communities, and soldiers serving in our areas of activity.	88,000$
Protected Transportation & Logistics Under Fire	Provision of protected transportation and logistics support, for Kedma's volunteers to border communities.	82,000$
Thermal Protection	procurement of 500 thermal clothing kits (tops and bottoms) for volunteers operating in border communities during extended outdoor shifts.	75,000$
Emotional Resilience Support	Deployment of social workers to provide emotional support for Kedma staff and volunteers	75,000$
First Aid Kits for Shelters	Equip 100 shelters with first aid kits	23,000$

These interventions are not long-term development programs - they are immediate stabilization measures designed to preserve community continuity, morale, and operational capacity during an active crisis.
Your support at this moment ensures that Kedma can remain present, responsive, and effective where resilience is being tested daily, during routine, and these days even more.

Sincerely,

Tirael Cohen,
President & Founder
Kedma -strengthening Israel's border communities